

Beef Crostini

Prep Time: 20 min **Cook Time:** 30 min

Ingredients

Crostini

150 g active sourdough starter — ideally recently fed and bubbly

250 g plain flour or bread flour

125 g warm water

5 g salt

10 g olive oil

Toppings

300g eye fillet steak

Capers

Rocket

Parmasean

Lemon zest

Horseradish cream

Pickled shallot

1 large shallot

60ml water

60ml white wine vinegar

1 tsp sugar

1/2 tsp salt

Preparation Steps

Make dough

1. Mix the 150 g starter, 125 g warm water and 10 g olive oil together.
2. Add 250 g flour and mix until there is no dry flour.
3. Leave for 20 minutes.
4. Add the 5 g salt and knead/fold the dough for 2–3 minutes until reasonably smooth.
5. The dough should be soft and slightly sticky but not soupy.
6. Cover and leave somewhere warm for approximately 3–4 hours.

Around every 30–45 minutes during the first 2 hours, give the dough a few folds:

Grab one side of the dough.

Stretch it upward.

Fold it over itself.

Rotate the bowl and repeat 3–4 times.

After that, leave it alone.

You don't need to wait for it to double. You're looking for it to become noticeably puffy, aerated and roughly 50–75% larger.

If your kitchen is cool, this may take closer to 4–5 hours.

7. Turn the dough onto a lightly floured bench.

Shape it into a small, fairly flat oval/batard rather than a tall loaf. You want bread that will produce small, thin slices rather than huge pieces.

Place on baking paper.

Cover and leave for another 30–45 minutes while the oven heats.

8. Heat your oven to 220°C conventional / 200°C fan.

Put the loaf in and bake for approximately:

25–30 minutes

You want it nicely browned and cooked through.

Remove and allow it to cool for at least 30–45 minutes.

You don't need it completely cold, but don't slice it while it's piping hot.

9. Once the loaf has cooled:

Slice it 5–8 mm thick.

Cut each slice into small pieces, approximately 4–5 cm across.

Arrange on a baking tray.

Brush very lightly with olive oil.

Bake at 180°C for about 8–12 minutes, turning once if necessary.

Remove when they're crisp and golden around the edges but not rock-hard.

Cool completely.

Pickle the shallot

10. Slice the shallot as thinly as possible into rings.
11. Put the vinegar, water, sugar and salt in a small saucepan.
12. Warm until the sugar and salt dissolve. You don't need to boil it.
13. Pour over the shallot.
14. Leave for at least 30 minutes. An hour is even better.
15. Drain well before using.
16. You can make these a day or two ahead and keep them refrigerated.

Cook beef

17. Preheat oven to 180 degrees
18. season beef generously with salt, pepper and a bit of olive oil
19. Sear on pan with high heat
20. Transfer to oven and cook until inside is 58 degrees for medium or 63 for medium well
21. Take out and rest
22. slice thinly and cool

Assemble

23. Small smear of horseradish cream.
24. One thin folded slice of beef.
25. A tiny piece of your pickled shallot.
26. One small rocket leaf.
27. A tiny Parmesan shaving.
28. One or two capers.
29. A couple of drops of olive oil.
30. Very small amount of lemon zest.
31. Black pepper.